ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	25th Commission Meeting
DATE:	06 May 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSION	DECISION
1	**Update on selection result – HRS** *HRS apprised the Commission that Ms. Kinley Wangmo, Dy. Chief Planning Officer, was selected for the post of Chief Planning Officer under the PPD, following the competitive interview conducted on 05 May 2026.*	**Noted.**
2	**Present proposal on translation of Judgment – LD** *LD apprised the Commission that, as of date, a total of 1,356 judgments related to corruption cases were rendered between 2006 and 2025. Of these, 130 judgments have already been translated, leaving 1,226 judgments pending translation.* *To this, LD presented a proposal received from the JSW School of Law to undertake the translation of the remaining judgments on a project basis. LD further apprised that, while private translators were also explored, the estimated cost was substantially higher. Under the proposal submitted by the JSW School of Law, the translation cost was estimated at Nu. 3,500 per judgment not exceeding 10 pages and Nu. 4,500 for judgments exceeding 10 pages, amounting to an estimated total cost of approx. Nu. 5.400 million. LD further apprised that the work would be undertaken in a staggered manner, whereby students would initially translate the judgments during their off-hours, followed by validation and review by faculty members.* *The Commission sought clarification from the LD on whether the total number presented comprehensively accounted for all judgments, including those that were reportedly missing or could not be located during earlier exercises. Recalling the experience from the translation of the initial 130 judgments, the Commission noted that the proposed arrangement lacked a definite timeline for completion and observed that the proposed approach may not adequately meet the intended objective of*	**Directed LD to ascertain the estimated timeframe for translating 50-100 judgments and accordingly initiate the project on a pilot basis for the first 50 or 100 judgments, with the estimated budget requirement to be adjusted from the next FY.**

	operationalising the knowledge management system within a reasonable timeframe. *Further, the Commission emphasised the need to determine a realistic implementation timeframe, particularly considering that the activity has not been budgeted for in the next FY and that the proposed cost is substantial. The Commission also noted that adopting a phased and measured approach may allow time for Machine Learning based translation applications being developed by the GovTech Agency and other relevant institutions to further mature, which could potentially support or reduce the translation burden in the future.*	
3	**Present proposal on compliance auditing – LD** *LD presented a proposal on conducting a compliance audit of the Asset Declaration Rules, covering areas such as submission compliance, internal controls, review mechanisms, record management, and follow-up procedures for the two declaration cycles of 2023-2024, with the audit expected to be completed by mid-June 2026. In this regard, LD proposed the following composition of the audit team:* *i) Sonam Tshering, Sr. Legal Officer;* *ii) Sonam Pelden, Legal Officer;* *iii) Tashi Wangchuk, Legal Officer; and* *iv) Sonam Choden, Legal Assistant.* *In addition, consistent with the practice adopted in the previous two compliance audits, LD sought the designation of one Commissioner as Advisor to the team.* *While acknowledging the objectives of the compliance audit, the Commission raised concerns regarding the proposed scope relating to the evaluation of the completeness, accuracy, and timeliness of asset declarations filed by covered persons, noting that such exercise may extend beyond compliance auditing into broader system-level assessment, thereby going beyond the intended scope of the current exercise and becoming overly tedious for the audit team.*	**Endorsed the proposal with following specific directives to:** - **undertake the exercise with focus on the overall assessment of Asset Declaration framework including policy clarity on Schedules of 'Covered Persons'.** - **designate Commissioner A Karma Rinzin as Advisor to the team, being the focal Commissioner for DoPE.**
4	**Update on the meeting with the FID, RMA – TC** *Technical Committee (TC) members to the AML/CFT, Mr. Sherab Tharchen and Mr. Thinley Tobgay, apprised the Commission on a meeting held with the Director, FID of RMA concerning the issue of foreign currency exchange activities involving Bhutanese nationals residing in Thailand under the King's Scholarship programme for undergraduate studies administered by the RCSC.* *It was apprised that the RMA acknowledged the concern and agreed to initiate an advocacy and awareness programme on the issue, noting that such intervention also aligns with its institutional performance targets. The*	**Noted and directed the IO concerned on the following:** - **communicate formally to the RMA on the case and seek their appropriate intervention and recourse at broader level.** - **communicate the matter to the RCSC and recommend incorporation of**

	RMA further suggested formally communicating the matter and also to the relevant authorities administering the scholarship programme. *To this, the Commission noted that the advocacy initiative proposed by the RMA may remain generic in nature, whereas there is an immediate need for targeted sensitisation of the specific individuals involved, particularly on the potential proliferation of risks associated with such activities, including exposure to money laundering and other related financial and legal risks.*	**AML/CFT related sensitisation as part of the briefing checklist for King's Scholarship candidates.** - **send individualised emails to the persons involved in the case, followed by phone calls, to sensitise them on the risks associated with large-scale foreign currency exchange activities under the AML/CFT framework.**
5	**Present proposal on NIA dashboard & dissemination plan – DoPE** *EAD apprised the Commission on the dissemination plan for the 6th NIA, aimed at enhancing outreach, visibility, and overall impact, including its contribution towards influencing international assessments such as the TI-CPI. In doing so, EAD proposed the launch of the 6th NIA Report on 27 May 2026 at Zhichenkhar, CBS, by the Chairperson, to be followed by a media Q&A session. It was further proposed that a media release be issued for wider public dissemination, including circulation to public servants through the RGoB email system.* *To further augment outreach and engagement, EAD proposed the following initiatives:* • *media engagement through interviews on BBS, led by the Commissioner In-Charge and officials from EAD;* • *media series highlighting key findings and tenets of the 6th NIA;* • *publication of journal articles in national and international platforms;* • *sensitisation programmes on the 6th NIA in collaboration with the ED and Regional Offices;* • *integrity counselling and consultation with low-scoring agencies to strengthen the AIMS; and* • *high-level leadership engagements through forums such as the conferences of Dzongdas, Gups, Principals, and other key stakeholders.* *In addition, EAD presented a proposal to develop an interactive dashboard for NIA findings in collaboration with the NSB. Following a detailed assessment of the advantages and limitations of such a dashboard, particularly from the perspectives of accessibility, data visualisation, interactivity, evidence-based decision-making, transparency, monitoring and evaluation, and sustainability, EAD proposed adopting a balanced*	**Endorsed both the proposals with the following specific directives:** - **explore the possibility of requesting the HPM or other relevant dignitaries as Chief Guest for the launch and accordingly finalise the programme. In the event of consent by HPM, coordinate a courtesy call-on to brief on the NIA in general and the launch event in particular.** - **reduce the duration of the launch programme to approximately 1.5 hours.** - **review and refine the proposed post launch activity plan including timelines for implementation.** - **publish journal articles in the Druk Journal, considering its outreach and readership.** - **ensure that dissemination and sensitisation with agencies are undertaken on a one-to-one basis rather than**

	approach to data disclosure, whereby disaggregated agency-level data would be shared directly with the respective agencies for internal improvement purposes. *To this, while acknowledging the importance of broad sensitisation and dissemination of the NIA findings, including its implications for international assessments and Bhutan's standing, the Commission emphasised the need to elevate the significance and visibility of the launch. In this regard, the Commission discussed the possibility of inviting high-level dignitaries, including the Hon'ble Prime Minister (HPM) or the Chairpersons of the GGC of the NA and NC, given the national relevance and strategic importance of the report.*	**through clustered engagements.** - **compile a list of relevant regional and multilateral partners, including the ADB, OECD, World Bank, IACA, BIG, and TI, among others, and share the report accordingly.**
6	**Follow-up to the bilateral meeting with the ECB – DoI, DoPS, DARe, LD, & PPD** *Following the bilateral meeting with the ECB regarding the upcoming Thromde, LG, NC, and NA Elections scheduled for 6 June 2026, 21 January 2027, April 2028, and 2029 respectively, the Commission deliberated on the following potential areas of collaboration and institutional support raised during the meeting:* *i) deputation of ACC officials to support the Dispute Settlement Bodies during the upcoming Thromde Elections;* *ii) strengthening the Election Monitoring Unit through possible support from the recently established CoRE Network;* *iii) strengthening the enforcement of IVRs;* *iv) strengthening the declaration and verification of assets;* *v) enhancing the capacity of officials in managing the Grievance Redressal Mechanism;* *vi) support towards the elementisation of election-related offences;* *vii) incorporating E-Learning courses on Ethics and Integrity Management as mandatory requirements for aspiring candidates, including integration into FLT and related advocacy programmes;* *viii) conducting sessions on ethics and integrity during the upcoming onboarding programme for nine (09) new recruits commencing from Tuesday;* *ix) formation of a small working team and debriefing by ECB on election and dispute settlement processes; and* *x) possible deputation of ACC officials as Election and Returning Officers during elections.*	**Endorsed the following team with one representative each to further liaise and coordinate with the ECB:** **i) Wangay Dorji, Director, DoPS (Focal);** **ii) LD;** **iii) DoI;** **iv) DARe; and** **v) ADMD, DoPE.**
7	**Regular update on Escrow Account – DoPS** *EMD apprised the Commission on the status of the Escrow Account for the month of April 2026, with an opening balance of Nu. 34,173,771.84 and a closing*	**Noted and directed to consult LD on whether the cash-in-hand relating to the seized IC in one case remains relevant**

	balance of Nu. 34,799,907.84. The increase included administrative sanctions amounting to Nu. 126,136.00 relating to 12 individuals across five cases and bail amount of Nu. 500,000.00 from three individuals pertaining to one case.	**for evidentiary purposes. Further, the Commission endorsed the use of the term "Maintenance" in place of "Refund from the OAG" considering the nature of the fund.**
8	**Invitation to observe 12th International Day of Yoga – PPD** *PPD apprised the Commission on the invitation received from the Indian Embassy to observe the 12th International Day of Yoga on 18 May 2026 with the ACC staff. In this regard, PPD sought the Commission's guidance on the number of ACC officials to be engaged for the programme.*	**Directed to involve all staff present at the HQ during the time of observance to participate in the programme, except in cases of exigency.**
9	Others - **Commission visit to Integrity Schools and Dzongkhags as part of Gyalsung POP** *PPD apprised the Commission on the preparatory arrangements for the Commission's engagements with the remaining Integrity Schools and Dzongkhag officials after attending the upcoming Gyalsung POP on 30 May 2026. In this regard, with the assumption that the Chairperson will be invited to attend the POP at the Gyalpozhing Gyalsung Academy, it was proposed that Commissioner Gyeltshen also attend the same programme and thereafter continue the visits to Tashiyangtse, Mongar, and Pemagatshel Dzongkhags, while Commissioner A Karma Rinzin undertake visits to Samdrup Jongkhar, Samtse, and Chhukha.* *However, as the POP coincides with prior engagements of ED officials with external partners, PPD sought the Commission's guidance on the proposed engagement plan, including the requirement for ED officials to accompany the Commission during the visits.* - **Letter delivery via Bhutan Post Corporation Ltd.** *The Commission discussed on the efficiency of the services provided by the Bhutan Postal Corporation Ltd. in the delivery of official correspondences, particularly within Thimphu. To this, the Commission recalled an instance where an official letter dispatched from Kawajangsa to Changzamtog reportedly took about 10 days for delivery, thereby undermining the urgency and sensitivity associated with the matter.*	**Directed to proceed with the planning and delegate the coordination of the visits to Integrity Schools and Dzongkhag officials in Tashiyangtse, Mongar, and Pemagatshel Dzongkhags to TRO for the Chairperson and Commissioner Gyeltshen, while the ED shall coordinate the visits for Commissioner A Karma Rinzin.** **Directed SS to review all categories of correspondences currently dispatched through Bhutan Postal Corporation Ltd. and present the same to the Commission for further decision.**

	- **Comparative analysis for catering services and venue for the upcoming IACA's Regional Expert Meeting** *PPD apprised the Commission that, based on the comparative analysis of accommodation arrangements quoted by three hotels viz. Le Méridien, Pemako, and Yarkay, with base room rates of approx. USD 200, USD 354, and USD 149 respectively, the IACA opted to proceed with Le Méridien, considering the past experience in hosting similar events and the availability of rooms. The cost for the rooms for the delegates will be borne by the IACA.* *Based on this, PPD further apprised the Commission of the comparative analysis on catering and venue related costs. The estimated cost for catering services, including buffet lunch and morning & evening tea with two veg and non-veg items, was approx. Nu. 0.810 million for Le Méridien, Nu. 1.080 million for Pemako, and Nu. 0.315 million for Yarkay. Similarly, the estimated venue and equipment hiring costs were approximately Nu. 0.855 million, Nu. 0.514 million, and complimentary respectively. Hence, PPD sought the Commission's guidance on the proposed catering and venue arrangements.*	**Directed PPD to further negotiate the cost with the Le Meridien as the cost for catering services and venue will be borne by by the ACC.**
	- **Venue for the upcoming Tripartite Meeting among the ACC, OAG, and RAA** *In continuation of the earlier deliberation on the venue for the upcoming Tripartite Meeting among the ACC, OAG, and RAA, the Commission noted the OAG's consensus to coordinate the meeting in Phuentsholing, along with overnight team-building excursion to Jigmechu.*	**Directed PPD to coordinate the booking of the venue at Jigmechu at the earliest, considering the peak winter season and the high volume of visitors during the period.**
	- **Sideline meeting during the upcoming Regional Seminar of ACI for Asia and the Pacific** *Chairperson informed the meeting about the delegation from Anti-Corruption Agency of Lithuania and proposed for a sideline meeting during the Seminar.*	**Directed PPD to include in the list of sideline meetings.**

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**